

TEACHERS UNION, LAUSD AGREE TO TERMS

The district remains in talks with two other labor groups, meaning a strike is still possible.

BY HOWARD BLUME AND KAREN GARCIA

Los Angeles school officials announced on Sunday morning that a tentative agreement has been reached with the teachers union, making it possible that a planned Tuesday strike could be averted.

The tentative two-year agreement with United Teachers Los Angeles would significantly increase salaries and raise the beginning teacher salary to \$77,000 per year.

The nearly 13.86% average increase is intended to “close the pay gap and strengthen recruitment and retention across the district,” according to a statement from UTLA. The ongoing cost of the agreement with UTLA is \$650 million per year, a district spokesperson said. In addition to salary hikes, the district has agreed to hire more counselors, give four weeks of paid parental leave and reduce class sizes in 11th and 12th grades.

L.A. Unified is continuing to meet with two other unions — Local 99 of Service Employees International Union and Associated Administrators of Los Angeles — to reach additional agreements that would avert a strike and keep schools open Tuesday.

If the other unions fail to reach a tentative agreement with L.A. Unified, the 37,000-member UTLA intends to wield its considerable power and honor the pickets of the other unions, according to UTLA, shuttering schools. The teachers union is able to do so because its agreement is not yet ratified, allowing union members to go on a solidarity strike, the union said in a bulletin to members.

“Over the last 14 months, educators were told to settle for less while the district sat on funds meant for classrooms and students,” said Cecily Myart-Cruz, UTLA president. “Our community knows schools succeed when educators are respected, fairly paid, and given the support to meet students’ needs.”

Julie Van Winkle, UTLA vice president, said the tentative agreement “directly tackles the challenges our schools have faced for years and delivers a historic win for those who make public education possible.”

Talks between UTLA and L.A. Unified unfolded Saturday. District negotiators were armed with the latest instructions and improved offers that emerged after a lengthy closed session of the school board on Friday.

Talks continue

Meetings with Local 99 were set for Sunday. In a midday statement, the union said leaders will continue to move forward with strike plans if an agreement [See **LAUSD**, A9]



JOHN GASTALDO For The Times



JAE C. HONG Associated Press

AT THE California Republican Party Convention in San Diego, supporters cheer on gubernatorial candidates Chad Bianco, top, and Steve Hilton, above.

Swalwell suspends campaign for governor

He continues to deny allegations of sexual assault

BY NICOLE NIXON AND SEEMA MEHTA

SAN DIEGO —Embattled Rep. Eric Swalwell suspended his campaign for California governor on Sunday but continued to deny he sexually assaulted anyone.

His campaign to succeed Gov. Gavin Newsom has all but collapsed as key Democratic supporters, including Rep. Nancy Pelosi and Sen. Adam Schiff, abandon him.

“To my family, staff, friends, and supporters, I am deeply sorry for mistakes in judgment I’ve made in my past,” Swalwell wrote on social media Sunday.

“I will fight the serious, false allegations that have been made — but that’s my fight, not a campaign’s.”

House ethics rules bar members from having sex with a subordinate, and House Democratic leader Rep. Hakeem Jeffries from New York is seeking an investigation into the allegations.

A former Swalwell staffer accused him of forcing himself on her twice when she was too intoxicated to consent, according to reports published by the San Francisco Chronicle and CNN. Three other women also accused Swalwell of misconduct that included sending and soliciting explicit photos and messages.

Swalwell’s woes were a topic of interest and amusement at the state Republican Party convention Sunday in San Diego.

The party did not endorse a candidate for governor on Sunday because neither of the top Republicans — Riverside County Sheriff Chad Bianco and former Fox News host Steve Hilton — received the support of 60% of delegates.

Bianco won 49% while Hilton had 44%; 7% of delegates voted not to endorse in the [See **GOP**, A10]

Studios shift more filming out of U.S.

U.K. and others have beefed up incentives, production expertise

By Samantha Masunaga



KATIE YU FX

COSMO JARVIS, center right, stars in the FX series “Shogun,” which is shot in British Columbia, Canada. [See **Incentives**, A12]

At the Burbank City Hall chambers packed with Hollywood union workers, community advocates and journalists, Sen. Adam Schiff (D-Calif.) laid out the cost of losing local film and TV production:

More than 42,000 jobs lost. Livelihoods destroyed. Future opportunities lost.

Increasingly, Schiff said, those jobs are being “lured abroad” by “foreign governments that have invested aggressively in building their own film industries.”

To underscore the point, Schiff cited some sobering data: Last year, 45% of all U.S. films and scripted television shows were shot internationally, up from about 33% in 2022.

California and other states have bolstered their production incentive programs, but it’s not enough, Schiff said. The former federal prosecutor was making the case for why a federal tax credit is needed to level the [See **Incentives**, A12]

Navy to begin blockade of all Iranian ports

The U.S. action in the Strait of Hormuz could further rattle global energy markets.

BY MUNIR AHMED, JOSH BOAK, SAM METZ AND SAMY MAGDY

ISLAMABAD, Pakistan — President Trump on Sunday said the U.S. Navy would “immediately” begin a blockade to stop ships from entering or leaving the Strait of Hormuz, after historic U.S.-Iran peace talks in Pakistan ended without an agreement or next steps in sight.

Hours later, U.S. Central Command announced that it will begin the blockade of Iranian ports on Monday at 10 a.m. Eastern.

Central Command said the blockade would be “enforced impartially against vessels of all nations” entering or departing Iranian ports and coastal areas.

It said it would still allow ships traveling between non-Iranian ports to transit the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump wants to weaken Iran’s key leverage in the war after demanding that it re-

open the strait to all global traffic on the waterway that was responsible for 20% of global oil shipping before fighting began.

A U.S. blockade could further rattle global energy markets. “It’s going to be all or none, and that’s the way it is,” Trump told Fox News.

Trump said he has “instructed our Navy to seek and interdict every vessel in International Waters that has paid a toll to Iran. No one who pays an illegal toll will have safe passage on the high seas.” Other nations would be involved in the planned blockade, he said, but did not name them.

Freedom of peaceful navigation is a basic principle of international maritime trade, but Iran has asserted control of the strait.

The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps later said the strait remained under Iran’s “full control” and was open for nonmilitary vessels but military ones would get a “forceful response,” two semiofficial Iranian news agencies reported.

During the 21-hour talks, the U.S. military said two destroyers had transited the strait ahead of mine-clearing work, a first since the war began. Iran denied that. [See **Navy**, A3]

ANALYSIS

Escalation could pull China straight into gulf conflict

BY MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — President Trump responded to the collapse of high-stakes negotiations with Iran by escalating the conflict on Sunday, ordering a full blockade of shipping through the Strait of Hormuz — a risky move that could drive global oil prices higher and provoke confrontation with a far more formidable adversary.

No country relies more heavily on the strait than China, which receives nearly half of its oil imports through the international waterway. In recent days, Beijing has warned that access to its shipping lanes “must be guaranteed.”

Trump administration officials believe the blockade could compel China to pressure Tehran into making further concessions, after Bei-

jing’s crucial role this month in convincing Iran to accept an initial ceasefire.

But the decision by U.S. diplomats to tie negotiations over the status of the strait to those over the fate of Iran’s nuclear program — a matter of torturous diplomacy for the last quarter of a century — could make it harder to secure a breakthrough.

In the meantime, a full blockade of the strait could force China to become more directly involved in a conflict that is already heightening tensions with Washington.

On Saturday, reports that Beijing could be preparing to send advanced missile and air defense systems to Iran prompted anger from the White House.

“If China does that, China is gonna have big problems,” Trump told [See **Analysis**, A3]



DENES ERDOS Associated Press

ORBAN CONCEDES DEFEAT

People react in the streets after partial results show the opposition party dominating the vote on Sunday in Hungary’s election. **WORLD**, A2

Salmon fishing poised to resume

Commercial crews will be permitted to work along the coast, albeit with strict catch limits. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

Weather

A shower in places. L.A. Basin: 69/52. **B5**

A new YA boom led by streamers

Streaming services are giving coming-of-age stories fresh relevance. **ENTERTAINMENT**, E1



Altadena slogs through challenges of rebuilding

By Grace Toohey

A few weeks after the first anniversary of the Eaton fire, the number of homeowners who neither put up their home for sale nor moved toward rebuilding has dropped to fewer than half, as more have taken some action toward recovery, according to data released Thursday by UCLA’s Latino Policy & Politics In-

stitute.

That total is a significant drop from where it was last summer, seven months after the fire destroyed thousands of homes in Altadena and surrounding neighborhoods, when about 70% of homeowners who suffered severe fire damage had neither put their property up for sale nor made a move toward rebuilding.

Though it’s the latest sign of progress in the Eaton

fire’s aftermath, researchers say that recovery remains far from settled for most fire survivors, even if they’ve started on a path to rebuilding.

The data show that there has been a new wave of people starting and advancing through the permitting process, but a widening lag after that point because of, among other reasons, financing.

About 44% of homeowners

have fully approved permits to rebuild, but only 30% have started construction, according to the data.

“This is the first step in a very long and extensive process,” said Gabriella Carmona, a senior research analyst at the institute and a lead author on the report. “Recovery is still very deeply uncertain for most households.”

Just under 50% of homeowners [See **Altadena**, A9]